PersianPulse

EVIDENCE DESK



Do you need a protein powder?

A quick evidence check

FOOD FIRST

Whole foods such as Greek yogurt, nuts, legumes and meat can supply protein. The RDA is 0.8 g per kg of body weight, about 50 g a day for a 140 lb person.

WHAT TESTING FOUND

Consumer Reports tested 23 powders and shakes. More than two-thirds had more lead per serving than its 0.5 mcg a day concern level.

9x

Plant-based powders averaged nine times the lead of dairy-based ones

0

Federal limits on heavy metals in supplements

BEFORE YOU BUY

Avoid products with a Proposition 65 warning, and ask a health professional if you have a specific need. Consumer Reports advises against daily use of high-lead products.

> **Food comes first. If you use a powder, look at the testing and keep it occasional.**

Sources: Consumer Reports protein powder testing, reported by NPR; Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health

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